Lesson 21 material: Enumerative Paragraphs 2: Model Paragraphs, Transitions and Writing

English Stage 2 (B2) · Unit 2: Sentences and Paragraph Types · American History

Unit 4 Enumerative Paragraphs (part VI-VIII)

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Original page, with audio and online exercises: https://harpercollege.pressbooks.pub/academic-writing-skills/chapter/unit-4enumerative-paragraphs/
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

VI. More Enumerative Paragraph Examples

EXERCISE

♠♠ Click here to review parts of a paragraph from Unit 3 Parts and Characteristics of a Good Paragraph: A paragraph should have: a title indentation in the beginning a topic sentence with the topic and controlling idea to show the main idea background information, if needed, before or after the topic sentence supporting sentences with some specific details to explain the main idea transitions to connect ideas between supporting ideas a conclusion to complete the paragraph a clear, logical order that presents a unified, cohesive, and complete paragraph For detailed explanations and practice in parts of a paragraph, open Unit 3 here.

Read each of the paragraph examples below and do the following activities:

1. Color code the paragraph:

Title – ***pink*** Topic sentence – ***red*** Supporting sentences – ***green***

Supporting details – ***blue*** Transitions – ***yellow*** Concluding sentence(s) – ***red***

2. Discuss:

- Have you had similar experiences or witnessed similar situations as described in this paragraph?
- Does the writer focus on telling a story, arguing for a controversial issue, or listing points to explain an idea?
- What types of supporting ideas and details are used to explain the main idea?
- Does the paragraph have unity?
- What information is included in the conclusion?
- Is the paragraph complete?
- Is the title centered on the topic line? Is the first sentence indented?
- What do you like about this paragraph?
- How do you improve the paragraph?
- If the writer were here, what question would you ask him/her about the paragraph?

Click for each paragraph:

EXERCISE

Paragraph #1 Shoes or No Shoes (by A. Zhumagulov): Shoes or No Shoes? It is puzzling to me why Americans wear shoes at home. There are there reasons why I am having a hard time understanding this custom. First, shoes are uncomfortable. When I come home, I want to relax. Arriving home in the evening, I need to switch my mindset to rest. When I take off my shoes, I subconsciously send a signal to my brain that the day is over and that it is time for rest. Street shoes like sneakers, dress shoes, and boots are just uncomfortable for the legs and feet. Secondly, wearing shoes at home is not hygienic. Outdoor shoes carry dirt. Even if we don't step on dirt, shoes accumulate a lot of dust when we go outside. Footwear is also a magnet for germs which can become a source of infectious diseases. The soles of the shoes are breeding grounds for harmful bacteria from parks, railway stations, or public toilets. This means that the bacteria, of course, remain on the soles. When I enter my own house, I just want to keep it clean without worrying too much about dirt and bacteria in it. Lastly, the culture in which I grew up is very different from the American culture in this area. In my country, it is not customary to wear shoes at home. I was brought up and taught to take off my shoes when I entered the house. It was like respecting the needs of the family members. I remember a time when I was punished at the age of five for running into the house in sneakers. In the same way, if I entered someone else's house with shoes off, I would be showing respect for the host. Taking off my shoes at home is a matter of habit for me. Maybe one day in the future, more people in America will follow this habit that brings comfort, cleanness, and respect. By A. Zhumagulov, Writing III, Harper College. Used with permission.

Paragraph #2: Unforgettable High School Years (by S. Kim): Unforgettable High School Years Three things from my high school are very memorable even though I was very tired most of the times then. First of all, I loved the physical education class. Students in Korea have a stressful life because of the pressure from competing for the best universities. I was no exception. I went to my regular school and then to a cram school from 8 am through 9 pm, and the physical education class was the only time I did not need to think about math or English. My classmates and I ran, jumped, and played basketball. Besides the PE class, I felt relaxed at lunch time. It was one and a half hours long, much longer than the 10-minute breaks. As soon as the lunch bell rang, my friends and I did not waste any time in rushing to the cafeteria. We would trade each other's lunches and tell jokes. The last good memory comes from the change of the hair policy. When I was a freshman, my hair had to be cut to as short as 8 millimeters, according to the school rule. I felt embarrassed, and even my mother teased me about my appearance. Fortunately, the government forced the school to change that rule a year later. I was able to wear my hair as long as I liked; as a result, I felt better about my appearance, and my self-confidence grew. My high school years have long passed, but those three memories still bring smiles to my face and to my heart. By S. Kim (student) , ESL Writing III, Harper College. U sed with permission.

Paragraph #3: My Favorite Hobby (by N. Traveras): My Favorite Hobby My favorite hobby is to watch Netflix. As an ESL student trying hard to improve language skills, I have been improving my English by watching the shows on Netflix because I can read and listen at the same time. For instance, two months ago, I watched "Lucifer". All the characters spoke good English, and the captioning allowed me to read the words they were speaking. When I did not understand some words, I wrote them down in my notecard and checked them in my dictionary. From "Lucifer", I learned many new words. Besides helping me learn English, the movies often transmit a good message. I once watched a movie "Breaking Bad". It teaches me that we have to love our family while they are alive before it is too late.

That message reminds me to have good relationships with my loved ones. Third, it is relaxing to watch Netflix after a tiring day of study and work. For example, “Merli” is a fun series about teenagers and the things that happen to them. It is light-hearted and helps me reduce my stress. I have learned that we have to enjoy life despite many challenges. Whenever I am exhausted, I think about that series and feel better. For these reasons, I like Netflix. I would recommend it to all my friends. By N. Traveras (student) , ESL Writing III, Harper College. U sed with permission.

Paragraph #4: My First Ever Road Trip (by C. L. Shi): My First Ever Road Trip I had some unique experiences on my first ever road trip when I was 20. My mom was living in Los Angeles, and I in Chicago then. When my summer break started, she came to Chicago and suggested that we drive to LA together. That would be my first road trip on a highway. Practically still a new driver, I had gotten my driver’s license less than a year before. I was afraid to go on the highway because many people drove over the speed limit and I could not maintain the minimum speed required. Fortunately, my mom was sitting next to me in the passenger seat, so I felt a bit more relaxed to drive on the highway. Second, this was the first time I drove for a long period of time. The farthest I had ever driven was to my friend’s house, 30 minutes away. This road trip was over 3,000 miles, and I drove for 3 days. My Mom tried to keep me awake by telling jokes and playing music on the car radio. When we were tired, we checked into a hotel near the highway. Finally, this was the first time I drove a car older than I. I had been driving a new car bought by my mom because it was safer for a new driver. However, this time, I was driving my mom’s car, made in 1998, for the first time! I was born in 2001. Everything in the car was old. There was no modern technology like the power windows and cruise control. The only comfort for me was knowing that it could not drive fast. For 3 days, we kept hoping that the car would not break down. When we arrived in LA safely, we were so happy. I did it! My mom was so proud of me. I felt like my life had just begun. I realized that there would be many obstacles to overcome in my future, but this road trip gave me confidence that I would be able to do everything I set my mind to. By C. L. Shi (student), ESL Writing III, Harper College. U sed with permission.

Paragraph #5: Writing Diary (by N. Oad): Writing My Diaries Writing a daily diary is important to me. First, it saves my good memories. At the end of the day, I like to write what has happened to me in my whole day. I write about my good times. For example, when I was in high school seven years ago, my friends and I went for trips, played games, and sang songs. I wrote about all this fun that we had together. Whenever I read my diary later, it feels so nice to look back on my good memories. Secondly, it keeps my secrets. My secrets stay safe in my diary. I don’t need to share them with anyone else. I can write my ideas that come to my mind. They are safe. Finally, writing makes me feel more at ease. I often worry about many things like my study and job, and I do not like to talk with others about them. However, after writing in my diary, I feel relaxed and can communicate with others more easily. I like writing, and writing diary is my passion. By N. Oad (student) , ESL Writing III, Harper College. U sed with permission.

Paragraph #6: Homesick for Spain (by L. K. Llabrés): Homesick for Spain I have lived in America for one year. Everything here makes me homesick for my country Spain. My family and friends have always been on my mind. For me, they are so important that they are a pillar in my life. When I go to sleep, I sometimes feel that I need a hug of my parents. When I go to the movie theatre, I feel alone because my sister is not with me. Also, when I read in the social media, I see pictures and videos of my friends getting together. It is strange to feel that the people who used to stay with me are now so far

away. One of the reasons I miss my parents is their food. My parents are both chefs, and growing up, I enjoyed the special homemade delicacies. In America, most of the food is processed and is not healthy. Therefore, I need to buy organic food, but it is a little expensive. I crave the traditional food in Spain, such as Spanish omelet, paella, pulpo a la gallega, and cocido madrileño. What I miss the most is my favorite dessert ensaimada. It is only made in my hometown Mallorca and is much more delicious than those made elsewhere in the country. Finally, I miss the beautiful beaches. One of my hobbies used to be walking on the sand in different seasons. With my bare feet, I could feel the changes in the temperature and texture of the sand. However, in Chicago, the winter temperature can dip so low that waking on the beach is not possible. I hope that I will get more used to the life here soon, but my native Spain is always going to home sweet home. By L. K. Llabrés (student), ESL Writing III, Harper College. U sed with permission.

Paragraph #7: To Communicate or Not to Communicate?: To Communicate or Not to Communicate Three subjects often cause disagreement between teenagers and their parents: friends, free time, and school. To begin with, it is hard for them to discuss friends. Teenagers tend to make friends based on “cool” aspects like popularity and appearance. However, their parents want to know if these friends are “good” students and have “good” behaviors. If some friends do not have good grades, or if they like partying, the parents may not want them to be their children’s friends. The second topic the adolescents and their parents often fight about is how to spend free time. Young people like to play games, go to the movies, and hang out with their friends. On the other hand, their parents consider those activities meaningless or a waste of time bur prefer to see their children read books, work out, and help with housework. The most frequent fight happens when they discuss study. The teenagers think that study is one part of their lives, but the parents believe that study should be all their children should do to prepare for a successful career. As a result of this disagreement, when they discuss future college majors, the parents often hope for careers in business, law, or health care because of the job opportunities and stable income. If their children have passion in music or literature, the family may be concerned about the job prospects. To sum up, the fights between the parents and their children often put everyone in a bad mood. Only time, love, and understanding will help restore harmony in the family.

Paragraph #8 The Inconvenience of Overseas Travels: The Inconveniences of Overseas Travels As more and more people travel overseas for personal or business reasons, they are faced with a few conveniences. The first trouble is to get their passports and visas. Even though it is easy to get them in some countries, it can be a major hassle for most people. For example, many small or remote towns do not have a foreign consulate, so people have to spend money and time going to a big city to get their visa. Once their visa is ready and they are all excited to leave, they must clear the hurdles at the airport security. There are usually long lines and intense checks. Occasionally a police dog may be used to sniff potential dangers in the crowd. It can be very scary. When the travelers are lucky to pass the security, they must face other new challenges of security and customs clearance in their destination countries after a long and fatiguing flight or sometimes a series of flights. In addition, luggage claim, a new language, and other issues can exhaust the already extremely tired body. The inconveniences do not end here. Many people struggle with terrible jet lag in the next two days to even weeks. If they go overseas to visit families and friends, they will not be able to enjoy the reunions right away, nor will they delight in the delicacies prepared to welcome them. If they have business affairs, their work is also

affected while they are trying to overcome the jet leg. When they finally feel at ease, it is time to travel back home. As interesting as overseas travels may be, travelers have to overcome obstacles from leaving to returning.

Exercise 5. Read the following paragraph. Is there a topic sentence? If not, add one. Is the paragraph unified? If not, cross out the irrelevant information. Can you add more interesting supporting details?

(Picture: athletic shoes, weights, jumping rope)

athletic shoes, weights, jumping rope

Winter Fun at Home

Winters in some areas of America are very cold. Many people have to stay indoors. The first interesting thing they can do is make home a fun zone. For example, they can set up a simple but comfortable home theatre with just a TV and a couch. A bag of popcorn and a cup of hot chocolate can add to a feeling of warmth and relaxation no matter how heavily it is snowing outside. A home theater like this is also fun in other seasons, so they can enjoy it year round. Second, they can make household chores into a competition, with prizes. For instance, they have a cleaning game every week. The older child will vacuum the carpet, the younger child will dust the furniture, and the parents will mow the lawn. They can rotate being the judge and deciding on the prizes. Children are usually happier to do housework when it is fun. Lastly, they can continue with physical activities at home. Gyms can be expensive, and people have to drive there. If they have a treadmill or stationary bike at home, that will be great. However, it is still fine without them. On the Internet, there are many training videos with no equipment needed, so everyone can choose what he or she likes to do including aerobics and tai chi. Winters can be long, but they do not have to be boring.

VII. Transitions in Enumerative Paragraphs

EXERCISE

♠♠ Click here to review transitions from Unit 3 Parts and Characteristics of a Good Paragraph: Transitions connect ideas and guide readers. The transitions before the first supporting idea and before the conclusion are often optional. “Finally” is for the last supporting idea in the body of the paragraph, not for the conclusion.

For detailed explanations and examples of transitions, open Unit 3 here.

You already know very well how to use transitions like “first, second, next, in addition, finally”. They are very useful expressions but not the only ones. Take a look at a variety of transitions used in the paragraphs in this unit. Notice the punctuation as well.

Enumerative paragraphs in this unit	**Transitions between the supporting sentences and before the conclusion**

Public Laundromats in the USA	... is the first problem.	The second problem is ...	The problems do not end here. The biggest problem is ...	(It is OK not to have a transition before conclusion.)
The Joy of Having My Three Children	First,	However, I feel really old sometimes, but they make me feel young.	The part I love the most is that ...	(It is OK not to have a transition before conclusion.)
To Communicate or Not to Communicate?	To begin with,	The second topic the adolescents and their parents often fight about is ...	The most frequent fight happens when ...	To sum up, (before conclusion)
My Favorite Hobby	(It is OK to not to have a transition before the first supporting idea.)	Besides helping me learn English,	Third,	For these reasons,
Writing Diary	First,	Secondly,	Finally,	(It is OK not to have a transition before conclusion.)
Unforgettable High School Years	First of all,	Besides the PE class,	The last good memory comes from ...	(It is OK not to have a transition before conclusion.)

Homesick for Spain	(It is OK not to have a transition before the first supporting idea.)	One of the reasons I miss my parents is their food. (to connect with missing parents in the first support.)	Finally,	(It is OK not to have a transition before conclusion.)		
The Inconveniences of Overseas Travels	The first trouble is to …	Once their visa is ready and they are all excited to leave, they must …	When the travelers are lucky to pass the security, they must face …	In addition,	The inconveniences do not end here.	(It is OK not to have a transition before conclusion.)

Exercise 6. The following paragraph is adapted from one in Unit 3. The transition before each supporting sentence is missing. Add an appropriate transition. The three supporting sentences are underlined, and you can combine each supporting idea with a transition. Try at least two transitions for each blank. Be careful with punctuation. The first one is an example.

Example:

(Picture: a balcony with a table, two chairs, and some plants)

a balcony with a table, two chairs, and some plants

_____(transition) <u>The balcony has a beautiful lake view.</u>

First, the balcony has a beautiful lake view.

The first reason I like the balcony is that it has a lake view.

My Special Place

Most people have their own special place in the house, and mine is my balcony. It is a wooden structure about 2 meters wide and 8 meters long. _____**(transition)** <u>The balcony has a beautiful lake view.</u> The balcony faces a small lake, and sometimes I see ducks swimming there. In the evening, the fountain in the middle of the lake lights up with soft music in the background. I always feel serene and mysterious with the night sky enveloping around me. _____ **(transition)** <u>The balcony is a place where I rest after a day of hard study.</u> No one bothers me there, and the noise from the house feels far away. My three young children often play in the living room, but they make an effort to play quietly when they see me in the balcony. They know it is "mommy time". _____ **(transition)** <u>It is a place where I reflect on my life.</u> There are 2 pots of geranium flowers and 2 pots of cacti, a perfect harmony of pink and green, round and thorny, soft and spiky – just like life itself, I think about my life experiences while admiring the plants. I love my balcony!

VIII. Unit Review Practice: Writing Assignments

Now you are ready to write your own enumerative paragraph! As you have learned in Unit 2 The Writing Process (*Open Unit 2 here)*, the best way to plan a paragraph is to follow the proper steps.

Enumerative Paragraph Writing Assignments

You will be writing two at-home enumerative paragraphs. The second one will start after the first one is complete. For both assignments, follow the instructions below.

Purpose: To show your understanding of planning and writing an enumerative paragraph. Use the writing process to help you.

Topic: Choose from the list below.

Brainstorm and Outline: Brainstorm for ideas. Then organize the ideas by using one the outline templates below. Your outline is due on _____. Bring it to class.

Paragraph: Your paragraph should have a title, a topic sentence, three supporting ideas with details, and a conclusion. Use proper transitions to connect ideas.

Format: Type your paragraph, double spaced, font size 12, with 1-inch margins on four sides of the page. Type your name, class, and date on the upper right-hand corner of the page. The first line of your paragraph should be indented. Save your paragraph in a Word file.

Self Checklist: When you finish writing, use the Self Checklist below. Put a checkmark beside each item if you think you did a good job in that area. Otherwise, improve your paragraph until you can check off the item. Save your work again.

Submission: Submit your paragraph on the Blackboard. Go to your Blackboard course site and follow the instructions there. Due by _____.

Choose one of the following topics. If you wish to write about a topic of your own, discuss with your professor first.

1. What is the most significant change you have experienced in your life since you turned sixteen? Explain three reasons why it is so important. (not three changes)
2. What are three advantages (or disadvantages) of Internet dating?
3. What are three advantages (or disadvantages) of social media?
4. What are the three reasons some people hold prejudices against some other people?
5. What are the three difficulties ESL students (or you) have in reading?
6. What are three good qualities of _____(a leader)? (Name a specific leader)
7. What are the three words to describe your personality?
8. What is an American custom you like very much? Explain three reasons why you like it. (Just one custom, not three)
9. What is an American custom you do not like? Explain three reasons why you do not like it. (Just one custom, not three)
10. What is one custom that you are the most proud of from your native country? What are the three reasons? (Just one custom, not three)

Enumerative Paragraph Outline Template #1

Parts of a Paragraph	Outline Ideas
Topic sentence	
Question:	
Supporting Sentence 1	
Details 1	
Supporting Sentence 2	
Details 2	
Supporting Sentence 3	
Details 3	

Enumerative Paragraph Outline Template #2

(Picture: hamburger paragraph outline)

hamburger paragraph outline

Enumerative Paragraph Self Checklist

Questions	**Paragraph Revising and Editing Self Checklist**	√
1	Is my paragraph on topic and clear to understand?	
2	Is my paragraph interesting to read?	
3	Did I include a topic sentence with a clear controlling idea?	
4	Did I include 3 supporting ideas and connect them with transitions?	
5	Did I include a concluding sentence?	
6	Is my paragraph unified and complete?	
7	Did all my verbs agree with their subjects (subject-verb agreement)? Did I use proper verb tenses (verb tense shift)?	
8	Did I try my best to use correct sentence structure (simple, compound, complex)?	
9	Did I try my best to use correct grammar such as nouns, pronouns, and others?	
10	Did I try my best to have correct spelling, punctuation, and capitalization?	
11	Did I follow the proper paragraph format?	

Note: #7 – #10 may include more specific aspects of grammar depending on how many editing units you have already studied.

NSNT Practice

(Picture: a pen writing in a notebook)

a pen writing in a notebook

Go to **The NSNT Free Writing Approach and Additional Weekly Prompts for Writing** in Appendix A. *(Open Appendix A here.)* Choose two topics to write a paragraph each. You may start with the NSNT approach and then revise and edit the paragraphs using the Self Checklist above. You are encouraged to share your writing with your partner and help each other improve.

EXERCISE

Writing task: You may write in your notebook or in the box below. (Warning: Once you leave this page, you will lose what you have written in the box.) .

Vocabulary Review

(Picture: a page in a dictionary)

a page in a dictionary

The words here have appeared in this unit. The best way to learn them is to guess the meaning of each word from the context. Then hover your computer mouse over the number beside each word to check its meaning and part of speech. These words are also listed in the footnote area at the end of each unit.

Here, you can use the flashcards below to review these words.

EXERCISE

- **relief**: noun, a feeling when the worry disappeared
- **controversial**: adjective, causing argument because of different opinions
- **typical**: adjective, common, showing the nature of something
- **barrier**: noun, a challenge or a difficulty that stops people from doing something
- **flexibility**: noun, the quality of being willing to change
- **humility**: noun, the quality of being humble, not proud
- **generosity**: noun, the quality of being willing to give things to others or sharing things with others
- **prospect**: noun about future
- **cross-country competition**: noun phrase, a sport of running long and different paths
- **imitate**: verb, follow or copy someone else's behavior
- **infrequently**: adverb, not often

Summary

1. An enumerative paragraph focuses on explaining a few points (reasons, ways, approaches, aspects, etc.) to support a main idea.
2. An enumerative paragraph should have a title, a topic sentence, 2-4 supporting ideas with details, a conclusion, and transitions.
3. Following the writing process (pre-writing, writing, and post-writing) can ensure a well – organized and well – supported paragraph.

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1. relief: noun, a feeling when the worry disappeared ↲
2. controversial: adjective, causing argument because of different opinions ↲
3. typical: adjective, common, showing the nature of something ↲
4. barrier: noun, a challenge or a difficulty that stops people from doing something ↲
5. flexibility: noun, the quality of being willing to change ↲
6. humility: noun, the quality of being humble, not proud ↲
7. generosity: noun, the quality of being willing to give things to others or sharing things with others ↲
8. prospect: noun, something about future ↲
9. cross-country competition: noun phrase, a sport of running long and different paths ↲
10. imitate: verb, follow or copy someone else's behavior ↲
11. infrequently: adverb, not often ↲